

TURKEY

2015

1	Overview of the tax-benefit system	2
2	Unemployment insurance	5
3	Unemployment assistance	9
4	Social assistance	10
5	Housing benefits for rented accommodation	14
6	Family benefits	15
7	Childcare for pre-school children	15
8	Employment-conditional benefits	16
9	Lone-parent benefits	18
10	Tax system	19
11	Part-time work	22
12	Policy developments	23
	Social security contributions to general government	24
	Social security contributions paid to institutions outside general government	24
	Payroll taxes	24

1 Overview of the tax-benefit system

According to Article 79 of the Law No. 5510 on Social Insurance and Universal Health Insurance, for short and long term insurances and universal health insurance, the Institution is obliged to collect, and the concerned parties are obliged to pay premiums in order to cover any kind of payment foreseen in the Law and management expenses. Universal health insurance premiums collected by the Institution shall be transferred directly to the universal health insurance section of the Institution budget, following collection.

Insurance benefits prescribed in the Law are financed by the premiums paid by employees and employers. The rates of the insurance premiums to be collected in line with this Law were regulated in Article 81, with the title “Premium rates and contribution of State”. Accordingly:

The rate of invalidity, old - age and survivors insurance premiums is 20% of the earnings of the insurance holder subject to premium. 9% of this is insurance holder's share, whereas 11% is employer's share.

Short term insurance branches premium rate is 2% according to Article 81. All of this premium shall be paid by the employer.

Universal health insurance premium shall be 12.5% of the earning subject to premium calculated pursuant to this Law, for individuals subject to short and long term insurance branches. 5% of this premium is insurance holder's share and 7.5% is employer's share. Universal health insurance premium for individuals subject to only universal health insurance shall be 12% of the earning subject to premium.

The State contributes to the Institution, at a rate of one fourth of the invalidity, old - age and survivors insurances and universal health insurance premium collected by the Institution per month. The amount to be calculated as contribution of state shall be payable to the Institution, by Treasury, within 15 days following the date of request.

According to the new regulation, premium shares to be paid for insurance holders, who are employed by one or more employer through a service contract, within the scope of paragraph (a) of Article 4 are shown below:

Insurance Branches	Employee's Share (%)	Employer's Share (%)	Total
Short Term Insurance Branches Premium	-	2	2
Invalidity, Old-age and Survivors Insurance Premium	9	11	20
Universal Health Insurance Premium	5	7.5	12.5
Unemployment Insurance Premium Rate	1	2	3
Total	15	22.5	37.5

For the private sector employers who employ insurance holders under item (a) of Article 4 of the Law, the amount corresponding to five points of employer share in the premiums of invalidity, old - age and survivors insurances are covered by the Treasury.

Premium shares paid by independent insurance holders who work on their own behalf and account, under item (b) of Article 4 of the Law are shown below:

Insurance Branches	Premium Rates Paid by Insurance Holders %
Short Term Insurance Branches Premium	2
Invalidity, Old-age and Survivors Insurance Premium	20
Universal Health Insurance Premium	12.5
Total	34.5

Premiums of independent insurance holders (4/b) are accrued by the Institution, from 01.01.2009, over the amount to be declared by themselves on the condition that they are in the range of lower and upper limits of daily earning subject to premium, and in case they do not declare, over the lower limit of daily earning subject to premium.

According to the Law No. 5510, the rate of invalidity, old - age and survivors insurance premiums is 20% of the earnings subject to premium of the insurance holder, for the insurance holders who become public servants (4/c) for the first time. 9% of this is insurance holder's share, and 11% is employer's share. Universal health insurance premium is collected from insurance holders who become public servants (4/c) for the first time, at a rate of %12.5 in addition to existing premiums. 5% of this premium is insurance holder's share and 7.5% is employer's share.

Premium shares paid by insurance holders who become public servants (4/c) for the first time, according to the Law No. 5510:

Insurance Branches	Employee's Share %	Employer's Share %	Total
Invalidity, Old-age and Survivors Insurance Premium	9	11	20
Universal Health Insurance Premium	5	7.5	12.5
Total	14	18.5	32.5

In return to duty disability pensions, being or will be paid to insurance holders under item 4/c and to survivors pensions to be granted to their dependants, additional return premium shall be

Reference date for all information is **July 1st 2015**

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collected at 20% of the state premium benefits allocated to social security institutions from public administrations' budgets for insurance holders in this scope. All of the allocated additional premium shall be payable in equal monthly installments, within six months following the beginning of the month following the effective date of institution budgets after approval of competent authorities. Additional premiums of administrations under general budget shall be covered from the allowance to be placed in the Ministry of Finance budget.

1.1. *Average production worker wage (APW)*

The national currency is the Türk Lirası (TL). Turkey has changed its national currency unit in 2005 (after 1 January 2005, 1YTL = 1 million TRL, after 1 January 2009, 1TL = 1 YTL). In 2015, TL 2.72 was equal to USD 1. For 2015, the average production worker earned 32 048 TL (Country estimate).

2 Unemployment insurance

Program name in local language		...
Insurance is voluntary(V) or compulsory(C) for employees		C
Employment record (E) and contribution (C) conditions		E + C: 600 days out of last 36 months, continuously in last 120 days
Waiting period (days)		0
Maximum duration (months)		10
Up-rating mechanism of the benefit		...
Calculation of unemployment insurance benefit:	initial benefit as % of calculation base	40%
	benefit at the end of legal entitlement period in % of calculation base	40%
	Calculation base(2)	Gross
	Permitted employment and disregards when receiving unemployment insurance benefit	No
Benefit provision (eligibility (E), generosity (G)) varies with	age	0
	family situation	0
	contract type	0
	other	0

Unemployment Insurance Law was put into effect in 1999. Unemployment insurance premium deduction was started on 01.06.2000 and the first payment was made to unemployed persons in March 2002.

Unemployment Insurance is a compulsory insurance that performs with insurance techniques, covering a proportion of the income loss due to unemployment, of those who have lost their jobs unintentionally without any fault, despite their will, ability, health and qualifications for work, for a period of time.

Among the insured persons who are in the scope of (a) clause of the first paragraph and the second paragraph of the fourth article of Law on Social Insurance and General Health Insurance numbered 5510, the ones who work with labour contract, the insured persons who are subject to funds stated in temporary twentieth article of Law on Social Insurance numbered 506, if they demand, the insured who work with part time labour contract according to law numbered 4857, persons who work in public transport vehicles such as taxi, dolmush, the persons who work with part time labour contract by one or more employers in the places determined by Ministry of Culture and Tourism who work less than 10 days a month are in the scope of unemployment insurance.

In the context of unemployment insurance, the following benefits and services are provided for unemployed insured persons by ISKUR:

- Unemployment benefit
- Universal Health Insurance premium payments required by the Law No. 5510
- Finding a new job
- Occupational and vocational training
- Advisory services

2.1 Conditions for receipt

2.1.1 Working conditions

Persons regarded as insured according to the Unemployment Insurance Law are entitled to receive unemployment benefits, provided that their labour contracts are terminated without their will and fault and they apply to Turkish Employment Agency (ISKUR) personally or electronically within the prescribed period (30 days) and declare that they are keen to have a new job, on the condition that they have worked for at least 600 days with insurance and paid unemployment insurance premiums within the 3 years before the termination of their contracts, and worked continuously and paid premiums for the last 120 days prior to leaving the job. In 30 days after the termination of labour contract, he/she should apply to closest ISKUR branch in person or www.iskur.gov.tr. (If it is not applied in 30 days except for force majeure, the delay time will be deducted from the total right of ownership period).

2.1.2 Contribution conditions

Unemployment insurance is compulsory. Unemployment insurance premiums are paid by the State, employer and the insured, in order to finance all kinds of payments and service expenditure necessary for unemployment insurance.

The unemployment premium is taken as 1% the insured person, 2% employer and 1% from the government share from the premium based monthly gross income. For voluntary unemployment insurance, the premium is taken as 1% the insured person and 2% employer share.

2.2 Calculation of benefit amount

2.2.1 Calculation of gross benefit

Daily unemployment benefit is 40 % of the daily average gross earning, calculated by considering the earnings taken as basis for premiums for the last 4 months. The amount of the unemployment benefit calculated as described above, cannot exceed 80% of the gross amount monthly minimum wage. At the first period of 2014, minimum 425,15 TL, maximum 850,30 TL and at the second period, minimum 450,16 TL, maximum 900,31 TL unemployment benefit was paid.

2.2.2 *Income and earnings except for benefit recipients and those starting a new job*

2.3 *Tax treatment of benefits and interaction with other benefits*

Unemployment benefits are not subject to any taxes or deductions other than stamp tax, except for alimony debts, it cannot be seized and transferred. The persons who are entitled to receive both job loss compensation (prescribed in Article 21 of the Law on Regulation of Privatization Exercises and Amendments in Certain Statutory Decrees, No. 4046, dated 24/11/1994) and unemployment benefits at the same time are paid the job loss compensation primarily.

Job loss compensation applications are regarded as unemployment benefit request applications as well.

Because of general economic, sectoral, regional crisis or force majeure, in case short time work is done in a work place, short time working allowance is paid by Unemployment Insurance Fund. In order to deserve the right for short time working allowance, the employee should have the conditions to have the right for unemployment insurance except for termination of labour contract. It is determined by law that the duration for short time working allowance is maximum 3 months and it is provided that short time work duration will be deducted from unemployment benefit duration determined in the beginning. Council of Ministers is entitled to extend the duration of short time working allowance to six months and determine whether it would be deducted from unemployment benefit.

2.4 *Benefit duration and waiting periods*

Workers who have and worked continuously and paid premiums for the last 120 days prior to termination of the labour contract and fulfilled the other requirements mentioned in the Law, are entitled to receive unemployment benefits for the following durations:

- Insured, unemployed persons who have worked with insurance and paid unemployment insurance premiums for 600 days within the last three years receive payments for 180 days.
- Insured, unemployed persons who have worked with insurance and paid unemployment insurance premiums for 900 days within the last three years receive payments for 240 days.
- Insured, unemployed persons who have worked with insurance and paid unemployment insurance premiums for 1080 days within the last three years receive payments for 300 days.

Unemployment benefits are paid to the unemployed person himself/herself at the end of each month and the first payment is made until the end of the first month following the date of entitlement to the benefit.

In case the insured person is employed before completing the unemployment benefit duration and gets unemployed before fulfilling the conditions for unemployment insurance benefit, prescribed in the Unemployment Insurance Law, he/she continues to benefit from this right until the end of the unemployment benefit period he/she became entitled before.

Reference date for all information is **July 1st 2015**

Country chapter for OECD series *Benefits and Wages* (www.oecd.org/els/social/workincentives)

If the person gets unemployed again, fulfilling the conditions prescribed in the Law, he/she is entitled to receive the unemployment benefits only for the duration that arises due to this new entitlement.

There is no waiting period for those entitled to unemployment benefits.

2.5 *Treatment of particular groups*

2.5.1 *Young Persons*

2.5.2 *Older workers*

2.5.3 *Others if applicable, including disabled*

Unemployment allowances are paid regardless of age, sex, marital status differences. Conditions and entitlements are the same for everyone.

3 Unemployment assistance

3.1 Conditions for receipt

3.1.1 *Employment conditions*

3.1.2 *Contribution conditions*

3.2 Calculation of benefit amount

3.2.1 *Calculation of gross benefit*

3.2.1.1 *Irregular additional payments*

3.2.1.2 *Obligations of family members*

3.2.2 *Income and earnings except for benefit recipients and those starting a new job*

3.3 Tax treatment of benefit and interaction with other benefits

3.4 Benefit duration and waiting periods

3.5 Treatment of particular groups

3.5.1 *Young persons*

3.5.2 *Older workers*

3.5.3 *Others if applicable, including disabled*

4 Social assistance

The State of the Republic of Turkey has taken destitute and poor citizens under protection, with Law No. 2022, on Granting of Pensions to Turkish Citizens Who Are Over the Age of 65 and Who Are Destitute, Infirm and Without Any Means of Support, As Well As Disabled Destitute Citizens, which came into effect on 10.07.1976. Thus, the State puts the citizens in need on salary taking certain criteria into account.

The persons in the scope of the Law are put on salary and their medical treatment costs are met according to the Law No. 3816 Pertaining To Meeting the Medical Expenses of the Citizens Without Means by the State through issuing a Green Card.

Within the scope of the Protocols, responsibilities of the Ministry of Family and Social Policies and İŞKUR have been identified under the title of ‘Activating the Relation between Social Assistances and Employment’. In accordance with the the Protocols, those, who apply and receive social assistance, are registered into TEA database via Integrated Social Assistance Services Information System.

OUTCOMES OF SOCIAL ASSISTANCE- EMPLOYMENT RELATION AS OF 01.07.2013- 30.06.2014	
ACTIVITIES	TOTAL
Directed Towards Vacant Job	36.812
Employed	15.337
Applied To Courses	22.018
Attended Courses	9.858

As of 14.07.2014, by means of all Social Assistance and Solidarity Foundations in 81 provinces, a new model has started to be implemented which anticipates incentive on condition that social assistance beneficiaries should attend employment-generating activities and envisages sanction in case they do not attend those activities. These are the features of the new model:

Incentive Supports for Employment

- “Job Guidance Assistance” is provided maximum 4 times in a year for expenses such as transportation, state of health, headshot photo etc. needed for the citizen to go to job interview and to be employed (40 TL-100 TL).
- “Assistance for Start Working” is provided for once only as much as one-third of gross amount of minimum wage in case the people guided for the job is employed (378 TL for the period between 01.07.2014 – 31.12.2014)
- People, who regularly keep at job, are primarily evaluated in heating, education and food assistances.
- In case beneficiaries of conditional education and health assistances are employed, their assistances will not be cut off during 12 months.

Sanction

In case social assistance beneficiary does not attend employment-generating activities without good cause, any “cash assistance” will not be provided by Social Assistance and Solidarity Foundations except from regular central assistances and in-kind assistances.



4.1 Conditions for receipt

According to the Law No. 2022, on Granting of Pensions to Turkish Citizens Who Are over the Age of 65 and Who Are Destitute, Infirm and Without Any Means of Support, As Well As Disabled Destitute Citizens, conditions for receipt are as below:

1. Old-age Pension (Pension for 65 years of age):

Citizens who are over the age of 65 and do not receive any income or pension from any of Social Security Institutions and whose income (total of all kinds of income or monthly average of alimonies provided by relatives responsible for alimony, whether paid or not) is below the indigence line are put on Old Age Pension. Indigence line is 1/3 of net minimum wages per individual.

2. Disability Pension for Persons over 65 and Requiring Care: (disability over %70)

“Disability Pension for Persons over 65 and Requiring Care” to the amount of 300% of old-age Pension is paid to the persons among our citizens, who are at the age of 65 and cannot survive without care of another person (disabled to the degree of %70 and over) and cannot benefit from an income or pension of any social security institution and whose monthly average of all kinds of income and maintenance income acquired or they are able to acquire from their relatives who are liable to pay in accordance with our Civil Code is below indigence line.

3. Disability Pension (disability between 40-69%)

Disability pension to the amount of 200% of indigence old age pension is paid to the ones among our citizens who are between 18-65 ages, have a degree of disability between 40%-69% and cannot benefit from an income or pension of any social security institution and whose monthly average of all kinds of income and maintenance income from their relatives who are liable to pay in accordance with our Civil Code is below indigence line.

4. Disability Pension for Persons Requiring Care (disability over 70%)

Disability pension for persons requiring care to the amount of 300% of old age pension is paid to the ones among our citizens who are between the ages of 18-65 and cannot survive without care of another person (disabled to the degree of 70% and over) and cannot benefit from an income or pension of any social security institution and whose monthly average of all kinds of income and maintenance income acquired or they are able to acquire from their relatives who are liable to pay in accordance with our Civil Code is below indigence line.

5. Pension for relatives of disabled (below the age of 18, disabled/invalid-disability of 40%)

Pension for relatives of disabled to the amount of 200% of old age pension is paid to the citizens who cannot benefit from an income or pension of any social security institution and whose monthly average of all kinds of income and maintenance income acquired or they are able to acquire from their relatives who are liable to pay in accordance with Civil Code on condition that they have disabled children and realize the nursing of their disabled relative at the age of 18.

4.2 Calculation of benefit amount

Pensions are calculated according to the amount which is derived from multiplying 1620 indicator digit by officer salary parameters which is determined each year by the Budget Act.

Old-age Pension (Pension for 65 years of age) is calculated by adding the minimum living allowance amount to the amount derived from multiplying 1620 indicator digit by officer salary parameters (indigence limit).

According to the Law No. 2202, the Amount of the Pensions Granted in 2013 and July 2014 is shown in the table below:

Beneficiaries	Benefit Amounts Paid in 2010 (TL)	
	July - December/2013 period	January - December/2014 period
1- Old-age Pension (Pension for 65 years of age)	130.62	141.18
2- Disability Pension for Persons over 65 and Requiring Care	391.86	423.54
3- Disability Pension (disability between 40-69%)	261.24	282.37
4- Disability Pension for Persons Disabled and Requiring Care (disability over 70%)	391.86	423.54
5- Disabled Relative Pension (Handicapped-Disabled below 18)	261.24	282.37

4.2.1 *Calculation of gross benefit*

4.2.1.1 *Irregular additional payments*

4.2.1.2 *Obligations of family members*

4.2.2 *Income and earnings disregards for benefit recipients and those starting a new job*

4.3 *Tax treatment of benefit and interaction with other benefits*

4.4 *Benefit duration and waiting periods*

4.5 *Treatment of particular groups*

4.5.1 *Young persons*

4.5.2 *Older workers*

4.5.3 *Others if applicable, including disabled*

Reference date for all information is **July 1st 2015**

Country chapter for OECD series *Benefits and Wages* (www.oecd.org/els/social/workincentives)

5 Housing benefits for rented accommodation

5.1 *Conditions for receipt*

5.2 *Calculation of benefit amount*

5.2.1 *Calculation of gross benefit*

5.2.2 *Income and earnings disregards*

5.2.3 *Costs eligible for housing benefits*

5.3 *Tax treatment of benefit and interaction with other benefits*

5.4 *Treatment of particular groups*

5.4.1 *Young persons*

5.4.2 *Older workers*

5.4.3 *Others if applicable, including disabled*

6 Family benefits

6.1 Conditions for receipt

6.2 Calculation of benefit amount

6.2.1 Calculation of gross benefit

6.2.1.1 Irregular additional payments

6.2.2 Income and earnings disregards

6.3 Tax treatment of benefit and interaction with other benefits

6.4 Treatment of particular groups

6.4.1 Young persons

6.4.2 Older workers

6.4.3 Others if applicable, including disabled

7 Childcare for pre-school children

7.1 Out-of-pocket childcare fees paid by parents

7.2 Child-care benefits

7.2.1 Conditions for receipt

7.2.2 Calculation of benefit amount

7.2.2.1 Calculation of gross benefit

7.2.2.2 Income and earnings disregards

7.2.3 Tax treatment of benefit and interaction with other benefits

7.2.4 Treatment of particular groups, including disabled

8 Employment-conditional benefits

Public Workfare Programs (PWP)

PWP are the programs aiming at short-term employment and training of the unemployed in the times of high unemployment, by realization of a work or a service for public good, directly or with a contractor. These activities are usually carried out to prevent the unemployed recorded in the Institution from losing their working routine and discipline, and experiencing financial difficulties due to long-term unemployment.

8.1 Conditions for receipt

1. To participate in PWP, the applicant must meet the following conditions:
 - a. Being unemployed and having a record in Turkish Employment Agency
 - b. At the age of 18 and older
 - c. Not receiving retirement, disability or survivor's benefit.
 - d. Not being student (except for faculty of extended education students)
2. In case of high demand for PWP, participants are determined by drawing before a notary public. Provincial Directorate shall specify in the notice which methods indicated below would be used for the selection of participants. The selected method will be used to identify both the main participants and substitute participants, which at least half of the main participants.
 - Notary draw method
 - List method (determination of applicants deemed appropriate as a result of interview or job and career counselling)
 - Eighty percent by the notary draw, twenty percent by the list method

8.2 Calculation of benefit amount

8.2.1 Calculation of gross benefit

Worker's wage expense is calculated according to the current gross minimum wage of a worker who is over 18 years old and working in the industry sector, and which is composed of wage, tax and social security payments. (Participants will receive a wage during PWP, which will be calculated over the current minimum wage, according to their duration of work.)

The Gross Minimum Wage paid between 1 January-30 June 2014 for the workers over 16 is 1.071 TL; 1 July-31 December 2014 for the workers over 16 is 1.134 TL.

8.3 Tax treatment of benefit and interaction with other benefits

Public Workfare Programs are taxed over gross wage.

Gross income	1.134 TL
Insurance premium (workers' share)	158.76 TL
Unemployment insurance (workers' share)	11,34 TL
Income tax	64,26 TL

Stamp tax	8,61 TL
Total deductions	242,9 TL
Net wage	891,03 TL

8.4 *Benefit duration*

1. Maximum duration of the programs is 9 months.
2. Programs can be arranged as full-time (45 hours per week)

8.5 *Treatment of particular groups*

It is essential that Participants are selected from the region closest to the place where Public Workfare Programs are implemented. The groups mentioned below, which are employed more difficult are put in the first list and the others are put in the second list, in the classification of the other applications. The applicants in the second list will not be assessed before the assessment of all the applicants in the first list. All the groups below belong to the first list and there is no order of priority among these groups.

- a) Women
- b) Individuals 35 Years and Over
- c) Disabled people
- d) Former sentenced persons
- e) Wounded in a way to not getting disability in the fight against terrorism

8.5.1 *Young persons*

8.5.2 *Older workers*

8.5.3 *Others if applicable, including disabled*

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Country chapter for OECD series *Benefits and Wages* (www.oecd.org/els/social/workincentives)

9 Lone-parent benefits

9.1 *Conditions for receipt*

9.2 *Calculation of benefit amount*

9.2.1 *Calculation of gross benefit*

9.2.1.1 *Irregular additional payments*

9.2.2 *Income and earnings disregards*

9.3 *Tax treatment of benefit and interaction with other benefits*

9.4 *Benefit duration*

9.5 *Treatment of particular groups*

9.5.1 *Young persons*

9.5.2 *Older workers*

9.5.3 *Others if applicable, including disabled*

10 Tax system

10.1 Income tax

10.1.1 Tax allowances and credits

10.1.1.1 Standard allowances

Reliefs for social security contributions: Employee's social security contributions are deductible from gross earnings. These contributions are 15 per cent of gross income as stated by the Social Insurance Act. The contribution to the unemployment fund is included in this amount and equals 1 per cent of gross income.

Contributions to public pension funds established by law are deductible.

Work-related expenses: None.

Minimum Living Relief: The calculation of the minimum living allowance is based on the annual gross amount of the minimum wage for employees older than 16 at the beginning of the calendar year in which the income is obtained multiplied by the following rates:

- 50 per cent for the taxpayer him or herself;
- 10 per cent for the spouse who neither works nor has an income;
- 7.5 per cent for each of the first two children;
- 10 per cent for the third child
- 5 per cent for each additional child.

This total amount is then multiplied by the rate (15 per cent) which is applied to the first income bracket of PIT Schedule stated in Article 103 of PIT Law, and then minimum living relief is calculated by offsetting 1/12 of the allowance amount against monthly calculated tax due on employment income. Any excess is non-refundable.

Reliefs for disabled: law 4842 regulates tax relief for disabled persons. The employee who lost his/her working capacity with at least 80 per cent is considered to be disabled in the 1st degree; employees are disabled in the 2nd respectively 3rd degree if they lost their working capacity with at least 60 respectively 40 per cent. In these cases, the following amounts are deductible from monthly wages:

- Disabled in the 1st degree: 880 TL
- Disabled in the 2nd degree: 440 TL
- Disabled in the 3rd degree: 200 TL

10.1.1.2 Non-standard tax reliefs

- Legal deductions for public institutions such as OYAK (Social Aid Institution for Military Officers)
- Contributions to private pension funds and premiums paid by the wage-earner for himself (or herself), the spouse and dependent children to personal insurance schemes covering death, illness, accident, disablement, maternity, birth and education, provided that the

insurance is contracted with a company established in or with a main office in Turkey. The total amount of deductible contributions to the private pension funds cannot exceed 15 per cent of the wage that is earned in the month when the premiums or contributions are actually paid. The annual amount cannot exceed the annual minimum wage either.

- Membership payments made to labour unions.

10.1.1.3 Standard tax credits

10.1.2 *Income tax schedule (central government income tax)*

The tax schedule in 2015 is as follows:

Taxable income (TL)	Tax on lower threshold (TL)	Tax on excess amount above lower threshold (%)
Up to 12.000		15
12.000 up to 29.000	1.800	20
29.000 up to 106.000	5.200	27
106.000 and over	25.990	35

10.1.3 *State and local income taxes*

Income tax is levied only by the central government.

10.1.4 *Stamp Tax*

The stamp tax base is gross earnings. The tax rate is 0.759 per cent in 2015.

10.2 *Treatment of family income*

10.3 *Social security contributions and payroll taxes*

Insurance benefits in Social Insurance and Universal Health Insurance Law No. 5510 are financed with premiums collected from employees and employers. According to the Law, lower limit of the daily earning subject to premium in calculation of premiums to be collected and benefits to be granted by is one thirtieth of the monthly minimum wage in effect and the upper limit is 6.5 times the lower limit of daily earning. Minimum wage is determined twice a year. There is no difference in terms of marital status or sex and the premiums are calculated according to the gross income.

Lower limit of the daily earning for a worker was 35.70 TL and the upper limit was 232.05 TL for the period January-June 2014.

For the period July-December 2014, lower limit of the daily earning for a worker was 37.80TL and the upper limit was 245.70 TL. Information on the amount of monthly income which is basis for allowances collected and premiums paid according to daily income limits are explained below:

Amount of monthly income which is basis for allowances collected and premiums paid in 2015:

Period	Lower Limit for Monthly Income (TL)	Upper Limit for Monthly Income (TL)
January-June/2014	40.05x30=1201.50	40.05x30x6.5=7809.75
July-December/2014	42.45x30=1273.50	42.45x30x6.5=8277.75

10.3.1 Contributions payable by employees and benefit recipients

Monthly premium amounts paid according to the premium rates valid for insurance branches, by insurance holders who are employed by one or more employers through a service contract (4/a) with minimum wage in 2015 are as follows:

Insurance Branches	Premium Rate %	Monthly Minimum Premium Amounts Paid by the Insurance Holder (TL)	
		January-June /2015	July-December /2015
Invalidity, Old-age and Survivors Insurance	9	1201.50 x 9% = 108.14	1273.50 x 9% =114.62
Universal Health Insurance	5	1201.50 x 5% = 60.08	1273.50 x 5% = 63.68
Unemployment Insurance	1	1201.50 x 1% = 12.02	1273.50 x 1% = 12.74
Total	15	180.23	191.03

10.3.2 Contributions paid by employers

Monthly premium amounts paid according to the premium rates valid for insurance branches, by an employer who employ an employee older than 16 with minimum wage (4/a) for minimum wage in 2015, are as follows:

Insurance Branches	Premium Rate %	Monthly Minimum Premium Amounts Paid by Employers (TL)	
		January-June /2015	July-December /2015
Short-term Insurance Branches	2	1201.50 x 2% = 24.03	1273.50 x 2% = 25.47
Invalidity, Old-age and Survivors Insurance	11	1201.50 x 11% = 132.17	1273.50 x 11% =140.09
Universal Health Insurance	7,5	1201.50 x 7.5% = 90.11	1273.50 x 7.5% = 95.51
Unemployment Insurance	2	1201.50 x 2% = 24.03	1273.50 x 2% = 25.47
Total	22.5	270.34	286.54

10.3.3 Payroll taxes

10.4 Treatment of particular groups

10.4.1 Young persons

The difference in minimum wage for the workers younger than 16 is omitted in 2015. Therefore, gross minimum wage for the workers younger than 16 is the same as the workers +16 (1201.50 TL for the first 6 half, 1273.50 TL for the second half of the year.) Monthly premiums for young employees are calculated as explained above.

10.4.2 Older workers

According to the Law No. 5510, social security contribution payments are collected from the insurance holders, who are receiving old-age pension and employed by one or more employers through a service contract (4/a), over the earnings subject to premium and with 30% addition to the short-term insurance branches premium rate. 7.5% of the 30% is insurance holder's share and 22.5% is employer's share. Short-term insurance branches premium, which is 2%, is added to employer's share of 22.5% and the total becomes 24.5%.

Social security contribution payments made by insurance holders, who are receiving old-age pension and employed through a service contract with minimum wage of 1273.50TL and social security contribution payments by the employers are shown below:

	Premium Rate %	Monthly Social Security Contribution Payments (TL)
Insurance Holder's Share (Contribution payment)	7.5	$1273.50 \times 7.5\% = 95.51$
Employer's Share (Contribution payment)	22.5	$1273.50 \times 22.5\% = 286.54$
Short-term Insurance Branches Employer's Share	2	$1273.50 \times 2\% = 25.47$
Total	32	362.88

10.4.3 Others if applicable

11 Part-time work

11.1 Special benefit rules for part-time work

Although there aren't any regulations about part-time work in Social Insurance and Universal Health Insurance Law No. 5510, experts and master teachers who are deemed to be insured within the scope of paragraph (a) of Article 4 and whose working days are less than 30 days, pay their premiums proportionally with their working time and they benefit from the risks covered by various insurance branches in a period longer than the insurance holders working full-time, regarding the number of premium payment days.

11.2 *Special tax and social security contribution rules for part-time work*

Information about the number of premium payment days for part-time work:

- In case the standard weekly working duration has been set as less than two thirds of the working time of a peer worker with full-time labour contract, it is called part-time working.
- Depending on the type of the written part-time labour contract signed by the employer and the insurance holder, in case it includes a clause on working for monthly wage, the insurance is declared as full month, regardless of the weekly working duration.
- If the labour contract has been signed on the basis of hourly pay, total working duration of the part-time worker in a month is divided into 7.5 hours, which is the usual daily working time according to the Labour Law No. 4857, in order to calculate the number of days for premium payment. In this calculation, the working duration which is less than 7.5 hours is accepted as a full day.
- Total working duration of the insurance holders working in the scope of the Maritime Labour Law No. 854, dated 20.04.1967 and the Law on Regulation of the Relations between Employees and Employers in the Press Profession No. 5953, dated 13.06.1952, is divided into 8 hours to calculate the number of days of insurance declaration. In this calculation, the working duration which is less than 8 hours is accepted as a full day.
- In case of on-call work, where it is agreed through a written contract that the action of working shall be performed when worker is required in relation with the work undertaken by him/her, monthly working duration of the insurance holder is calculated according to the duration on which the parties agreed if the working time is determined as day, week or month and according to the provisions above if the working time is not determined as day, week or month. If the working time exceeds the duration determined by the parties as day, week or month, this duration is taken into account in the calculation of the number of days for the insurance declaration, in accordance with the provisions mentioned above.

12 Policy developments

12.1 Policy changes introduced from 2 July 2014 – 1 July 2015

12.2 Future policy changes announced since 1 July 2015

ANNEX

DEFINITION OF SOCIAL SECURITY CONTRIBUTIONS AND PAYROLL TAXES.

The following text has been adapted from Annex A of the OECD *Revenue Statistics*.

Social security contributions to general government

Classified here are all compulsory payments that confer an entitlement to receive a (contingent) future social benefit. Such payments are usually earmarked to finance social benefits and are often paid to institutions of general government that provide such benefits. However, such earmarking is not part of the definition of social security contributions and is not required for a tax to be classified here. However, conferment of an entitlement is required for a tax to be classified under this heading. So, levies on income or payroll that are earmarked for social security funds but do not confer an entitlement to benefit are excluded from this heading and shown under personal income taxes or taxes on payroll and workforce. Taxes on other bases, such as goods and services, which are earmarked for social security benefits are not shown here [...] because they generally confer no entitlement to social security benefits.

Contributions for the following types of social security benefits would, *inter alia*, be included: unemployment insurance benefits and supplements, accident, injury and sickness benefits, old-age, disability and survivors' pensions, family allowances, reimbursements for medical and hospital expenses or provision of hospital or medical services. Contributions may be levied on both employees and employers.

Social security contributions paid to institutions outside general government

Contributions to social insurance schemes which are not institutions of general government and to other types of insurance schemes, provident funds, pension funds, friendly societies or other saving schemes [are included here if they are compulsory or quasicompulsory (e.g., by virtue of agreement with professional and union organisations)]. Provident funds are arrangements under which the contributions of each employee and of the corresponding employer on his/her behalf are kept in a separate account earning interest and withdrawable under specific circumstances. Pension funds are separately organized schemes negotiated between employees and employers and carry provisions for different contributions and benefits, sometimes more directly tied to salary levels and length of service than under social security schemes.

Payroll taxes

This heading covers taxes paid by employers or employees either as a proportion of payroll or as a fixed amount per person, and which do not confer entitlement to social benefits. Examples of taxes classified here are the United Kingdom national insurance surcharge (introduced in 1977), the Swedish payroll tax (1969-1979), and the Austrian Contribution to the Family Burden Equalization Fund and Community Tax.